



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

Divisional Operations Support Team Policy and Standard Operating Procedures

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1.0 Introduction

Operational support is a critical component of an organization's ability to maintain efficiency, respond to emerging challenges, and ensure continuity of service. The Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF) recognises the essential role of operational support in enhancing readiness, minimizing disruptions, and maintaining a high standard of service across all formations. This capability enables the rapid movement of equipment and personnel wherever necessary.

This policy and Standard Operating Procedures (SOP) establishes a systematic approach to preserving public safety. It incorporates interdepartmental coordination protocols for intelligence-driven anti-gang initiatives and sets clear performance benchmarks for the rapid deployment of resources in hotspot zones. Additionally, it aligns the operational support function with evidence-based strategies aimed at reducing the socioeconomic impact of organized crime.

2.0 Purpose

This policy and SOP provides a structured framework for the effective planning, coordination, and delivery of support services essential to operational readiness. It also establishes guidelines for the utilization of specialized expertise, intelligence gathering, and the use of technology to combat crime.

3.0 Scope

This policy and SOP applies to all sworn members of the JCF. It covers the responsibilities and functions to be carried out by Divisional Operations Support Teams (DOSTs).

4.0 Policy Statement

The JCF will apply policy oversight to:

- 4.1 maintain a robust and standardized operational support framework that ensures the effective deployment of resources, personnel, and equipment;
- 4.2 ensure that all members adhere to the guidelines outlined in this policy and SOP to promote coordination and enhance operational readiness; and
- 4.3 increase the integration of technical support to facilitate timely responses to both planned and emergency operations.

5.0 Abbreviations and Acronyms

DOST Divisional Operations Support Team

6.0 Definitions

6.1 Critical Incidents

High-priority, high-impact events that pose a significant threat to public safety. These incidents require an immediate and coordinated response from the JCF to prevent or mitigate harm.

6.2 Divisional Operations Support Team

A specialized team of police officers providing operational support within policing divisions to combat crime.

6.3 High Value Target

An individual on police records who is classified as a significant perpetrator or influencer of crimes.

6.4 Operational Support

The utilization of specialized tactical expertise and resources to manage high-risk operations.

7.0 Responsibilities

7.1 The Deputy Commissioner of Police, Strategic Operations Portfolio, is responsible for providing oversight on operational support island-wide.

7.2 The Assistant Commissioner of Police, Specialized Operations Branch, has the responsibility to:

7.2.1 ensure that members assigned to specialized operational sections, units and teams are proficient in the various levels of tactical training; and

7.2.2 develop and maintain a programme approved by the DCP Strategic Operations for the specialized operational training of members.

7.3 The Divisional Commanders have the following responsibilities

7.3.1 Manage the coordination of the division's operational assets in alignment with JCF strategic priorities.

7.3.2 Direct and monitor the purpose, utilization and impact of the Division Operation Support Teams;

7.4 The Divisional Operations Officer is responsible for:

7.4.1 managing the deployment of the Divisional Operations Teams within the division;

7.4.2 managing and coordinating the operational activities of the DOST;

7.4.3 providing leadership to the operational staff through;

7.4.4 identifying suitable members to be assigned to the DOST;

7.4.5 ensuring that all members of DOST are vetted in accordance with JCF policy requirements for sensitive posts;

7.4.6 ensuring that all operational units are adequately and appropriately staffed; and

7.4.7 coordination of the divisional operational assets in line with the initiatives of the Divisional Policing Plan.

- 7.5 **The Divisional Administration officer is responsible for:**
- 7.5.1 identifying and scheduling of members of the division to participate in the relevant operational courses;
 - 7.5.2 submit the recommendation for members to be sent on the refreshers' course, where required; and
 - 7.5.3 ensure that members of the DOST are sensitized on procedures outlined in this policy and SOP.
- 7.6 **Divisional Duty Officer** is responsible for maintaining communication with the DOSTs in order to coordinate the resources allocated adequately.
- 7.7 **The Proactive Supervisor/Operations Sub-Officer is responsible for:**
- 7.7.1 scheduling routine patrol activities, where required;
 - 7.7.2 ensuring that visits to assigned patrols are conducted;
 - 7.7.3 leading on planned proactive operational activities, where required;
 - 7.7.4 monitoring major incidents which occur during tour of duty;
 - 7.7.5 updating the Operations Officer on all important matters that occurred during tour of duty;
 - 7.7.6 preparing and submitting end-of-shift reports;
 - 7.7.7 ensuring members are properly equipped to carry out their functions; and
 - 7.7.8 ensuring that members of the DOST are properly briefed and debriefed.
- 7.8 **Members assigned to the DOST are required to:**
- 7.8.1 disrupt and curtail the activities of gangs and armed criminals in order to reduce murders, shootings, armed robberies and other serious crimes;
 - 7.8.2 carry out their functions in accordance with their specialised training and procedures outlined in this policy and SOP;
 - 7.8.3 conduct intelligence-led policing/operation assisted by Canine Division and the Caribbean Search Centre aimed at arresting high value targets, seizure of guns and drugs;
 - 7.8.4 execute daily targeted raids and cordon and search, focusing on gangs and public spaces such as: hot spots, taxi stands, bus parks, fishing villages, markets and places that come under suspicion;
 - 7.8.5 conduct soft and hard lockdowns of areas dominated by gangs;
 - 7.8.6 employ vehicle check point, people check point, space domination and appropriate modes of patrols to maximize the recovery of contrabands and arrest of roving criminals; and
 - 7.8.7 deter criminality in the crime hotspots through the use of focused proactive tactics.

8.0 Standard Operating Procedures

The following outlines the procedure for the Divisional Operations Support Teams.

8.1 Deployment of the Divisional Operations Support Team

- 8.1.1 The DOSTs are required to operate within their divisional space by providing support to local patrols and responding to assignments given.
- 8.1.2 Upon being assigned, ascertain the relevant information including the nature, location and severity of the incident to determine the appropriate response.
- 8.1.3 The procedures outlined in the JCF Patrol and Emergency Policy and Standing Operating Procedures must be adhered to in carrying out their respective functions.
- 8.1.4 The relevant DOST, Operations Officer, and shift supervisor should be notified of unplanned assignments that require their response.

8.2 DOST Request for Additional Support

- 8.2.1 The situation should be immediately and clearly communicated to the Operations Officer or Divisional Duty Officer, who should make the necessary arrangements to provide the support requested by the DOST.
- 8.2.2 Communication should be maintained to ensure adequate coordination and timely allocation of resources advantageous to the DOST's safety and effectiveness.

8.3 Risk Assessment of Critical Incidents

When an assignment or unfolding incident is assessed as a critical incident or involves a high-value target;

- 8.3.1 DOST personnel should use their training and equipment to ensure safety and prevent the escalation/widening of the area of concern.
- 8.3.2 A senior officer (on the scene or informed) should take command of the situation, coordinate communication lines, response/containment strategies, and initiate reconciliation and monitoring.
- 8.3.3 Sufficient resources should be brought in to overwhelm the situation/target and cauterized any sporadic or residual events inimical to public safety.
- 8.3.4 Members should conduct periodic risk assessments, employ tactical withdrawal to protect assets where practical and use operational safety procedures.

9.0 Legislative Authority/Guiding Principles

- 9.1 Constabulary Force Act;
- 9.2 Road Traffic Act;
- 9.3 Dangerous Drugs Act;
- 9.4 The Firearms (Prohibition, Restriction and Regulation) Act (2022);
- 9.5 Law Reform (Fraudulent Transaction) Act;
- 9.6 The Criminal Justice (Suppression of Criminal Organization) Act;

Appendix: Organizational Chart (Divisional Operational Support Teams)

